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- A. Image 1 depicts the Kaaba, a holy site in Mecca for the religion of Islam. Since this is such an important location for the Islamic religion, the city of Mecca and the site of the Kaaba strongly display the impacts of Islam on the environment. In the background, you can see two ornate pillars, likely minarets. Minarets denote holy places of the Islamic religion, especially mosques. There are also many pilgrims depicted around the Kaaba, showing that the influence of Islam has attracted adherents to the religion from all around the globe. The cultural landscape is overflowing with the influence of the Islamic religion in the architecture of the city, which contains many geometric shapes characteristic of Islam, the mosques, with their towering minarets, the temple of the Kaaba, and in the populations themselves.
- B. In ethnic religions, the global distribution of the population tends to be located within one region or at least within a singular ethnic group that is near the religion's place of origin. For example, Hinduism is predominantly concentrated in India, the place where the religion originated. Since ethnic religions tend to appeal to only a certain ethnic group, they do not diffuse through expansion diffusion. Rather, these religions are dispersed globally through relocation diffusion. Judaism is the prime example of an ethnic religion that has spread globally due to relocation diffusion, usually due to persecution rather than to gain converts. However, in recent years we have seen many Jewish people return to their religion's place of origin, Jerusalem. Ethnic religions tend to be distributed globally in small amounts due to relocation of families, while predominately located near the original hearth.
- C. The wailing wall in Jerusalem is predominately holy to the Jewish religion because it is an original part of their homeland. However, Judaism has also influenced the religions of Christianity and Islam, both of which contain similar texts of the Jewish religion. This can result in holy places such as Jerusalem depicted above to attract multiple religions. Christians, Jews, and Muslims all visit holy sites in Jerusalem such as the Western Wall because they are significant to the shared cultural beliefs of all three religions.
- D. Relocation diffusion can account for the spatial patterns of international travel to pilgrimage locations because it creates new pockets of the religion in distant locations. For example, Islam spread to Southeast Asia through the relocation of merchants. Today, Islam is one of the major religions in that region, especially in Indonesia. This relocation diffusion has caused greater Islamic populations to arise further from the holy sites near the hearth of the region. This has caused increasingly long patterns of international travel to these sites, drawing religious adherents from new regions and locations.
- E. Ethnic nationalism results when a certain ethnic group experiences a strong surge of nationalism and believes that they deserve improved rights or superior status. This can result in one religious group wanting control over holy sites that another religious group has control over. This is usually caused by the shared beliefs of those religions, like the ones of Christianity, Judaism, and Islam. In India and Pakistan, for example, the predominately Islamic Pakistan is fighting the predominantly Hindu India for control over holy sites near the border. Pakistan extremists have even been seen bombing certain holy sites in India in hopes to intimidate India into relinquishing them.